

COMMUNICATION STUDIES

The Communication Studies Major

comst.las.iastate.edu (<https://comst.las.iastate.edu/>)

The Communication Studies (COMST) program is the social science academic unit focused on human communication. COMST majors study communication theories and research in interpersonal/family, small group, organizational, leadership, intercultural, digital, and health contexts. COMST majors learn how to use evidence-based communication strategies to build healthy relationships, effectively navigate conflict situations, lead and work collaboratively in small groups, and affect positive change in their organizations and communities. The COMST curriculum prepares students for careers that require communication expertise and competence. Our alumni have secured jobs in account management, human resources, sales, training and development, recruitment, talent acquisition, youth development, business operations, event planning, social media strategy, law, international affairs, and public relations.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, Communication Studies majors will...

- Develop foundational knowledge of human communication.
- Apply human communication strategies in a changing world.
- Evaluate and utilize evidence-based research.
- Cultivate communication competence.

University-wide Requirements

To meet the University's Communication Proficiency (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#communicationproficiencypolicytext>) requirement, students are required to take:

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
	or ENGL 2500H Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition: Honors	

Plus one of the following or any 3000- or 4000- level COMST course not used to fulfill the upper division requirements for the COMST major.

ENGL 3020	Business Communication	
ENGL 3090	Proposal and Report Writing	
ENGL 3140	Technical Communication	

A grade of C or higher is required in ENGL 2500 Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition (or ENGL 2500H Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition, Honors).

Total Credits 9

Students in all majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities and a three-credit course in International Perspectives. (COMST 3100 fulfills the international perspective requirement/COMST 2100 and SPCM 3230 fulfill the U.S. Cultures and Communities requirement). Approved courses are listed at: <http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/courses/div-ip-guide.html> (<http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/students/div-ip-guide/>). Discuss with your advisor how the two courses that you select can be applied to your graduation plan.

LAS College Requirements

As majors in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Communication Studies students must meet College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/#lascollegerequirementstext>) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) for graduation in addition to those stated above for the major.

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits, including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level. Students must also complete the LAS world language requirement, career proficiency requirement, and LAS general education requirements. In accordance with college requirements, an overall average in Communication Studies courses of C (2.0) or better is required. This means students need a 2.0 GPA in the 33 hours taken to fulfill the major requirements in Communication Studies.

The Communication Studies Major

Communication Studies majors must earn at least 120 credits, with 45 credits at the 3000-4000 levels, and a minimum of 33 credits in COMST.

Core Requirements (15 credits)

COMST 1010	Introduction to Communication Studies	3
COMST 3010	Communication Theories	3
COMST 3030	Introduction to Communication Research Methods	3
COMST 4040	Research Seminar	3
Plus two of the following:		6
COMST 2100	Communication and U.S. Diversity	
COMST 2110	Interpersonal Communication	
COMST 2140	Professional Communication	
COMST 2180	Communication and Conflict Management	
SPCM 2120	Fundamentals of Public Speaking	

Total Credits 18

Upper Division Requirements (15 credits). Select five courses from the following

COMST 3100	Intercultural Communication	3
COMST 3110	Relational Communication	3
COMST 3130	Leadership Communication Theories	3
COMST 3140	Organizational Communication	3

COMST 3170	Small Group Communication	3
COMST 3190	Communication Training and Development	3
SPCM 3230	Gender and Communication	3
COMST 3250	Nonverbal Communication	3
COMST 3270	Persuasion and Social Influence	3
COMST 3300	Communication in a Digital World	3
COMST 4120	Health Communication (also available at the graduate level: COMST 5120)	3
COMST 4500A	Special Topics in Communication Studies: General	3
COMST 4700	Family Communication Dynamics (also available at the graduate level: COMST 5700)	3
Total Credits		15

optional Courses

COMST 4900	Independent Study	1-3
COMST 4970	Professional Internship	1-3

Communication Studies, B.A.

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 Elective	3
COMST 1010	3 Social Science Choice	3
Humanities Choice	3 Humanities Choice	3
LIB 1600	1 International Perspectives Course	3
Natural Science Choice	3 COMST 2110	3
COMST 1040	1	
14		15

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
World Language/Elective	3-4 World Language/Elective	3-4
ENGL 2500	3 Elective	3
Humanities Choice	3 Math Choice (STAT 1010 recommended)	3-4
Social Science Choice	3 COMST 3030	3
COMST 2100, 2140, 2180, or SPCM 2120	3 Natural Science Choice	2-3
	LAS 2030	1
15-16		15-18

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
COMST 3010	3 Upper Division Comm. Requirement	3

U.S. Cultures and Communities Choice	3 Upper Division Comm. Requirement	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Humanities Choice	3
Elective 3000+	3 Elective - 3000+	3
Social Science Choice	3 Elective - 3000+	3
15		15

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Upper Division Comm Requirement	3 COMST 4040	3
Upper Division Comm Requirement	3 Upper Division Comm Requirement	3
Any Elective	4 Verbal Comm--ENGL 3020, 3090, or 3140	3
Electives 3000+	3 Elective 3000+	3
Elective 3000+	3 Elective 3000+	3
16		15

Total Credits: 120-124

The Communication Studies Minor (18 credits)

The requirements for a minor in COMST may be fulfilled by credit in:

COMST 1010	Introduction to Communication Studies	3
COMST 3010	Communication Theories	3
Select one (1) 2000-Level course:		3
COMST 2100	Communication and U.S. Diversity	
COMST 2110	Interpersonal Communication	
COMST 2140	Professional Communication	
COMST 2180	Communication and Conflict Management	
Plus 3 3000-level courses, (9) credits from the following:		9
COMST 3100	Intercultural Communication	
COMST 3110	Relational Communication	
COMST 3130	Leadership Communication Theories	
COMST 3140	Organizational Communication	
COMST 3170	Small Group Communication	
COMST 3190	Communication Training and Development	
COMST 3250	Nonverbal Communication	
COMST 3270	Persuasion and Social Influence	
COMST 3300	Communication in a Digital World	
COMST 4120	Health Communication	
COMST 4500A	Special Topics in Communication Studies: General	
COMST 4700	Family Communication Dynamics	

Students must earn an overall average of C (2.0) or better in all courses taken for the minor.

The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement.

Total Credits **18**

The Communication Studies Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor. In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.